

Last-Gen Garmin & Coros Sports Watches — AU Prices

Software & experience: Garmin vs Coros for a female Ironman athlete

Garmin

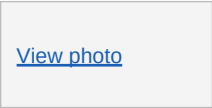
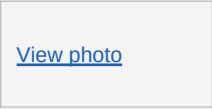
- **Interface:** touchscreen + 5 buttons on the AMOLED models; highly customisable data screens, watch faces and Connect IQ apps.
- **Triathlon:** mature multisport/triathlon profiles with transitions, open-water swim, and the widest bike-sensor support (power meters, Edge bike computers, Varia radar).
- **Coaching:** Training Readiness, HRV status, recovery time and daily suggested workouts on the watch; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** long-established menstrual cycle and pregnancy tracking in Garmin Connect, with phase-based training tips.
- **Everyday:** Garmin Pay, richer notifications; app can feel busy.

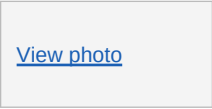
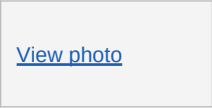
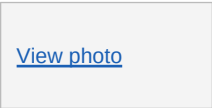
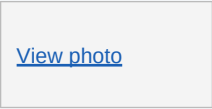
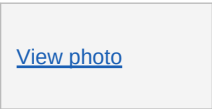
Coros

- **Interface:** buttons + digital crown (touch mainly for maps); simple, fast and glove/wet-hand friendly, but fewer customisation options.
- **Triathlon:** solid triathlon mode with transitions and open-water swim; fewer bike-sensor features than Garmin.
- **Coaching:** free Training Hub web platform with strong load/fatigue analytics and structured workouts; syncs with TrainingPeaks.
- **Women's health:** menstrual cycle tracking added Oct 2025 – predictions on the training calendar, watch reminders on every Coros model listed.
- **Everyday:** no payments, basic smart features; much longer battery for the money.

For Ironman racing: plan for up to the 17-hour cut-off. Most watches here cover that in full GPS. The **Forerunner 265** manages 14 h in multi-band mode, so race in SatIQ (16 h) or GPS-only (20 h); the **Forerunner 165** manages 19 h but has no multi-band; the **Epix Pro 42mm** manages 13 h multi-band, so race it in all-systems (21 h) or GPS-only (28 h) – the 47mm (~42 h) has no such worry. For comfort over a long day, the Vertix 2S is the heaviest; the Forerunner 265S, 965, Epix Pro 42mm, Pace 3 and Pace Pro sit better on smaller wrists. **Best all-round picks:** Forerunner 965 (maps, AMOLED, light, ~\$699 on Amazon); Epix Pro if she wants a premium metal build and flashlight (47mm ~\$762 on Amazon) or, on a budget, Coros Pace Pro (~\$565) / Pace 3 (~\$430).

"Last gen" = the model each brand has since replaced (as of 9 Oct 2026). Prices are the most recent AU listings found via price-comparison sites; retailer sites could not be checked directly, so confirm before buying. "Not listed" means no current listing was found.

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Garmin Epix Pro (Gen 2) 42mm / 47mm 2023 · replaced by Fenix 8 AMOLED  View photo	Kogan: Not listed now (was \$699 EOFY deal) JB Hi-Fi: 42mm Sapphire: \$1,699 (Aug 2026) Amazon AU: 47mm: \$762 (seen \$722–\$812)	• AMOLED + built-in LED flashlight • 42mm size (58–63g) suits smaller wrists • Full maps, multi-band GPS • 47mm: ~42h GPS – easily covers an Ironman • Big discounts where still stocked	• 42mm battery is tight: 13h multi-band, 21h all-systems • No speaker/mic, no dive depth sensor • Buttons not leak-proof • Stock is scarce – being cleared out	HR: Elevate Gen 5 optical ECG: Hardware capable; app not approved for this model in AU (2025) SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light, LED flashlight
Garmin Forerunner 965 2023 · replaced by Forerunner 970 (2025)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not listed Amazon AU: \$698.84 (RRP \$999)	• AMOLED, light (~53g) with titanium bezel • Full maps + multi-band GPS • Training Readiness, HRV, race predictor • Strong battery for an AMOLED	• Plastic case feels less premium • No flashlight, speaker or ECG (970 has all) • Older HR sensor than 970 • Now hard to find new in AU	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Garmin Forerunner 265 2023 · replaced by Forerunner 570 (2025)  View photo	Kogan: 265S only: \$572 (Aug 2026) JB Hi-Fi: 265S only: \$499 sale (was \$799, undated) Amazon AU: \$699 (dips to ~\$498 on deals)	• AMOLED touchscreen at mid-range price • Multi-band GPS • Training Readiness, HRV status, onboard music • Two sizes (265 / 265S)	• No maps (breadcrumb only) • Battery shorter than 965 • No flashlight/speaker/ECG • Standard 46mm size getting scarce	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Multi-band (SatIQ) Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light
Garmin Forerunner 165 2024 · replaced by Forerunner 170 (May 2026)  View photo	Kogan: \$329 (Jul 2026, may be out of stock) JB Hi-Fi: Not listed Amazon AU: \$399 (seen \$330–\$348)	• Cheapest AMOLED Garmin runner • Very light (~39g) • HRV status, Garmin Coach plans • Music version available	• No multi-band GPS • No Training Readiness / load focus • No maps • Battery ~11 days	HR: Elevate Gen 4 optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Single-band multi-GNSS Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / not confirmed Thermometer: Yes Extra: Ambient light
Coros Pace Pro 2024 · replaced by Pace 4 Pro (Sep 2026)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$565 (list \$649.95)	• AMOLED + offline maps at a Forerunner 265 price • Excellent battery for AMOLED • Dual-frequency GPS • Light, free training platform	• Thicker than rivals • Smaller app/watch-face ecosystem than Garmin • No contactless payments • Superseded by Pace 4 Pro	HR: Coros optical (updated) ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –
Coros Pace 3 2023 · replaced by Pace 4 (Oct 2025)  View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$429.95	• Ultralight (~30g) • Long battery (~24 days) • Dual-frequency GPS for the price • Cheapest serious running watch here	• MIP display, less vivid • No maps • Plastic build • No payments, limited smart features	HR: Coros optical ECG: No SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –
Coros Apex 2 Pro 2022 · replaced by Apex 4 (Oct 2025)  View photo	Kogan: \$820 (Aug 2026) JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: Currently unavailable	• Titanium + sapphire build • Very long battery (~30 days) • Offline topo maps • Dual-frequency GPS	• MIP display • Oldest hardware in this list • Kogan price is high for its age • No payments, limited apps	HR: Coros optical ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: –

Model	Price (AUD)	Pros	Cons	Sensors
Coros Vertix 2S 2024 flagship · successor not yet confirmed View photo	Kogan: Not listed JB Hi-Fi: Not stocked (JB doesn't carry Coros) Amazon AU: \$1,149.95	• Huge battery – weeks of use, days of GPS • Offline maps, titanium/sapphire • Dual-frequency GPS • Built for ultras and expeditions	• Large and heavy (~90g) • MIP display • Pricey • No payments	HR: Coros optical ECG: Electrode – HRV spot-check, not medical ECG SpO2: Yes GNSS: Dual-frequency Alt/Compass/Gyro: Yes / Yes / Yes Thermometer: Yes Extra: LED flashlight

Photos: this environment blocks image downloads, so each model links to a photo search instead. Prices gathered 9 Oct 2026 from search snapshots; dates show when a price was last seen where known (Amazon snapshot dates unknown). Amazon prices link to the listing. Coros "ECG" electrodes are used for HRV readings, not medical AFib detection.